STEAM Sources Sought Notice Amendment

NIH Scientific & Technical Expertise Acquisition & Management

Sources Sought Reference Number: 75N98027R00012
Amendment Number: 0002
Date Issued: November 10, 2026

Purpose of amendment

This amendment revises the requirements for a respondent to be considered capable of supporting Task Area A or Task Area B. Full coverage of every identified labor category is required within each task area for which the respondent seeks to be considered capable. Task Area B also requires support for all identified BSL and ABSL levels. NIH will assess capability separately for each task area; capability in both task areas is not required.

The Sources Sought Notice is amended as follows.

1 Introduction

Replace the second paragraph under "Introduction" with the following:

Interested small businesses may respond for Task Area A (Professional Services), Task Area B (Highly Specialized Scientific Services), or both. Respondents should identify their ability to perform as a prime contractor, joint venture, or subcontracting team, distinguish their own capability from that of team members, and identify limitations within each task area addressed. NIH will assess capability separately for each area. **To be considered capable of supporting a task area, respondents must demonstrate that their proposed performance arrangement meets the full capability requirements stated for that task area below.** Capability in both areas is not required to respond. Partial capability is insufficient to be considered capable of supporting the full task area. The Government has not made a final set-aside determination.

2 Task Area A Professional Services

Add the following paragraph immediately after the existing Task Area A description and before its labor-category list:

To be considered capable of supporting Task Area A, respondents must demonstrate the ability to fill every labor category identified under this task area with personnel who meet the applicable role-specific qualifications. Responses must address capability across all labor categories and identify any limitations. Capability in only a subset of the identified labor categories is insufficient to be considered capable of supporting Task Area A.

3 Task Area B Highly Specialized Scientific Services

Replace the two descriptive paragraphs under Task Area B, before its labor-category list, with the following:

This area covers scientific research and development, specialized scientific computing and analysis, laboratory services, and all clinical and animal-care roles, including associated routine support. Assignments may support basic, translational, or clinical research and specialized containment environments. Qualification requirements vary by role; not every category requires a doctoral degree or BSL-3 experience.

Task Area B may include support for Biosafety Level (BSL) 1, 2, 3, and 4 laboratories and Animal Biosafety Level (ABSL) 1, 2, 3, and 4 environments, as specified in individual task orders. Support for BSL-3 and BSL-4 laboratories remains a significant specialized requirement.

To be considered capable of supporting Task Area B, respondents must demonstrate the ability to fill every labor category identified under this task area with personnel who meet the applicable role-specific qualifications and to support all BSL and ABSL levels identified above. Responses must address capability across all labor categories and containment levels and identify any limitations. Capability in only a subset of the identified labor categories or containment levels is insufficient to be considered capable of supporting Task Area B.

4 Capability statement instructions

Replace the opening paragraph under "Capability Statement/Information Sought" with the following:

Submit a separate, clearly labeled capability statement for Task Area A, Task Area B, or each area if responding to both. Each statement must address capability across every labor category identified within the task area addressed. A Task Area B statement must also address capability across BSL-1 through BSL-4 and ABSL-1 through ABSL-4. Each statement should describe the project-based services and labor categories supported, contractor personnel expertise and availability, current capacity, comparable project experience, management capability, and customer references. Identify unsupported categories, unsupported containment levels, and other limitations, as applicable. Disclosure of a limitation does not waive the full capability requirements stated for the applicable task area. Responses should address the following for each task area selected:

5 Containment capability information

Replace the containment-specific paragraph immediately preceding item (3) under "Capability Statement/Information Sought" with the following:

The containment-specific information below applies to all respondents addressing Task Area B. For each BSL-1 through BSL-4 and ABSL-1 through ABSL-4 level, identify relevant contract performance experience, specialties, annual capacity to mobilize contractor personnel, maximum concurrent contractor personnel assignments, normal recruitment timeframes, and limitations. Distinguish company capability from proposed team-member capability and demonstrated experience from projected capacity. Identify unsupported levels; experience at one level does not establish readiness for another. If comparable experience at a level is unavailable, identify other evidence supporting the proposed capability at that level. Cross-reference item (7) without double counting capacity across levels. Support for all identified levels is required to be considered capable of supporting Task Area B. Item (3) places particular emphasis on BSL-3, BSL-4, ABSL-3, and ABSL-4. A-only respondents may identify this item as not applicable.

Replace item (3) with the following:

(3) Experience furnishing and managing qualified contractor resources for BSL-3 and BSL-4 laboratories and ABSL-3 and ABSL-4 environments. Identify specialties, numbers of contractor personnel supporting performance, and relevant performance examples. If comparable experience is unavailable, identify other evidence supporting the proposed capability. Explain how training, competency, occupational health, and access prerequisites are verified and coordinated with the receiving facility. Provide aggregate readiness information without medical records, sensitive laboratory security details, or unnecessary personal information.

6 Teaming information

Replace item (6) under "Capability Statement/Information Sought" with the following:

(6) The proposed prime, joint venture, and subcontractor roles, including the task areas and assigned categories, expected work shares, commitment status, and the prime's management responsibilities. Identify the ability to meet applicable small-business eligibility and performance requirements if a set-aside is selected. Explain how the proposed performance arrangement provides coverage for every labor category within each task area addressed and, for Task Area B, all identified BSL and ABSL levels. Individual team members may provide portions of the required capability, but the proposed arrangement must collectively demonstrate full coverage for the respondent to be considered capable of supporting the applicable task area. Clearly identify gaps in full-scope coverage and any discrete portions that could be supported separately. Capability limited to discrete portions is insufficient to be considered capable of supporting the full task area.

7 Concurrent capacity

Replace item (7)(b) under "Capability Statement/Information Sought" with the following:

(b) Concurrent capacity: State the maximum number of active task orders and contractor personnel assignments the company could sustain at the same time. Explain the assumed number and mix of personnel assignments per order, order duration, geographic coverage, and constraints. For Task Area B, address constraints for specialized scientific assignments and BSL/ABSL assignments at each of the required BSL-1 through BSL-4 and ABSL-1 through ABSL-4 levels.

8 Response deadline and remaining provisions

Respondents that previously submitted a capability statement may submit a revised statement addressing these amended requirements. Any revised statement must be clearly identified as revised and must comply with the notice's existing page limits and submission instructions. The Government will assess capability statements against the requirements of the notice as amended.

The response deadline remains November 16, 2026, at 11:59 p.m. Eastern Standard Time (EST). Revised capability statements must be received by that deadline to be assured consideration.

Except as expressly revised by this amendment, all other provisions of the Sources Sought Notice remain unchanged. This remains a sources sought notice for market research and is not a solicitation for proposals, proposal abstracts, or quotations.